

FinAssist — Revision Progress Report

Where the app stands against the FinAssist Front-End Development Plan (Flutter) · Branch **revisedfrontend** · 18 September 2026

Where we are	Detail
Core track (Phases 1–10)	Phases 1 to 9 are built and in the app. Phase 10 (History & Reconciliation Timeline and the rest of the Settings polish) is the only core phase left.
ML track (Phases 11–16)	Not started. Receipt scanning and voice input already work as standalone screens from the earlier app, and the chatbot answers from fixed keyword rules; none of them create transactions yet.
Quality	231 automated tests pass and the Flutter analyzer reports no issues. Every phase was also opened and used on an Android emulator.
Code	Phases 1–8 are pushed to the branch (latest pushed commit 29191ca). Phase 9 and this report are committed together with it.

This report lists what is already in the app, what was deliberately left out or removed, what is still missing, and the plan for each remaining phase.

1. Foundations and decisions behind the build

These were settled before Phase 1 and every later phase follows them:

- **Accounts and data:** Firebase Authentication with email or Google, and Cloud Firestore for storage. Writes are not waited on and reads use Firestore's local cache, so recording money works with no signal and syncs later.
- **One wallet ledger:** every income, expense and transfer belongs to a wallet, and the wallet's balance is written in the same batch as the entry, so a balance can never disagree with its history.
- **Peso only,** no currency picker, as the plan requires. Amounts show centavos only when there are any (₱20,000 and ₱270.25).
- **Four tabs** (Home, Transactions, Goals, Wallet) with a centre + button, and Settings and the AI assistant as header icons.
- **One colour rule for buttons:** green commits, red destroys or backs out, blue only opens or edits.
- **Light and dark mode** from a shared colour set, pulled forward from Phase 10 on request.
- **Nothing was rewritten from scratch:** existing screens were revised, and only features the plan removes were deleted.

2. Phases already built and integrated

Phase 1 — Login, onboarding and the app shell

- Splash screen with auto-login, real Firebase password-reset email, and Google sign-in.
- Onboarding: welcome, name, reminders question, income and ranked priorities, starting wallets and balances, then a recap. It stops at wallets, which is what the plan asks of Phase 1.
- Main shell with the four tabs, the + quick-add sheet, and the chat and settings icons in the Home header.

Phase 2 — Wallets and money entry

- Wallets list with the combined balance, each wallet's balance, and which wallet receives the income; add, edit and remove wallets.
- Wallet detail: balance, who pays into it, and that wallet's history, with transfers readable from both sides.
- Expense, income and transfer entry, each tagged to a wallet.

- A one-time, user-started import of records from before wallets existed. They appear in history without moving any balance.

Phase 3 — Bill Planner

- Bill schedules plus a record for each occurrence, so one month can be changed without touching the schedule.
- Due dates are worked out from the first due date; a bill due on the 31st still falls due in February.
- Month grid with colour-coded status dots, a list view and a day filter.
- Mark paid, pay part of it, skip, undo, and a breakdown of each payment with the wallet it came from. Paying writes the bill status, the expense and the wallet balance in one batch.

Phase 4 — Income Allocation Waterfall

- Adding income is three steps: amount, source, wallet and date; then the open bills with editable amounts (pay in full, pay part, leave for later, skip); then what is left, and Confirm.
- Everything is saved in one batch: the income, every bill payment, every skip, the goal contribution and a record of the cycle.
- If the chosen bills cost more than came in, the summary says the difference comes out of what the wallet already held.

Phase 5 — Transactions

- One list of every income, expense and transfer across all wallets, grouped by day, with bill payments and pre-wallet records labelled.
- Money in and money out for what is on screen; filters by type, wallet, category and date range; a spending-by-category sheet.
- Tap an entry to edit or delete it. Deleting a bill payment also undoes it on the bill.
- Money lent, borrowed or paid back is listed separately as "Loans in" and "Loans out", since it is neither earning nor spending.

Phase 6 — Safe to Spend and the leftover review

- Home's main card: what can be spent today against a daily limit, with a progress bar, today's spending, a privacy eye, and an explanation of how the figure is reached.
- Recommended limit = (wallet balances – bills due this pay period – savings set aside – money set aside for goals) ÷ days left in the period. Leaving the limit box empty uses that recommendation; typing a number sets your own.
- Pay periods come from the onboarding income frequency, anchored to the day income actually arrived.
- On a pay period's last day Home offers the leftover review: save it, spend it, split it, or decide later, with a status badge kept for the record.

Phase 7 — Goals, plus Debts (added)

- Goals tab: active and completed goals, priority order, progress, target date, and a goal step inside the income waterfall.
- Money set aside for a goal stays in its wallet, so wallet balances keep matching real life, while Safe to Spend stops counting it.
- Goal detail: progress ring, projected finish date from the pace of past contributions, contribution history, add or take out money.
- Goal planning: money already saved, a weekly, twice-monthly or monthly plan, what is needed each time to hit the target date, and whether you are on track or behind.
- **Debts (beyond the plan):** installments you pay, whose payments become a bill schedule that ends after the last payment, and money others owe you, with repayments recorded into a wallet.
- **Grow Your Money guide (beyond the plan):** a suggested monthly saving of 20% of income and plain-language cards on emergency funds, savings accounts and time deposits, labelled as education, not

advice.

Phase 8 — Reports, and Home rebuilt on the ledger

- Reports: this week, this month or a custom range, with arrows to step back and forth.
- Totals for income, expenses, money saved to goals, and the net change.
- A spending donut by category; tapping a category opens Transactions filtered to it for that period.
- A money-in versus money-out bar chart that starts at your first record, so months before you used the app are not drawn as zero.
- Plain-language insights, e.g. "Food spending is 20% higher than your 3-month average", only once there are earlier periods to compare with.
- Home was rebuilt on the same ledger: Safe to Spend first, then Total Balance, this month's spending as a split bar, recent transactions, and the top insight.

Phase 9 — Reminders (this phase)

- Notifications scheduled on the phone itself, so they arrive with the app closed and with no internet.
- **Bills:** a heads-up before the due date and one on the day, both at 9 AM, for anything unpaid.
- **Saving plans:** on the goal's own saving days at 9 AM, repeating the planned amount, or what is needed to reach the target date.
- **Leftover money:** 7 PM on the last day of the pay period, and 9 AM the next day while a finished period is still undecided.
- **Logging:** 8 PM on days nothing has been recorded yet.
- Tapping a reminder opens what it is about: the bill, the goal, the Add Expense form, or Home for the leftover question.
- Home also shows a "Bills due soon" notice for anything overdue or due within three days, so nothing is missed even with notifications off.

3. How reminders follow each user's priorities

Onboarding asks people to rank what matters most to them. Until this phase that answer was stored and never used. Now it decides which reminders start on, so two users with different priorities get different reminders.

Priority ranked by the user	Reminder it controls	On by default?
Pay bills on time	Bills due	Always on. Ranked first, the heads-up comes 3 days early; otherwise 1 day.
Save toward a goal	Saving plans	On when ranked 1st or 2nd
Build general savings	Leftover money	On when ranked 1st or 2nd
Just track my spending	Log your spending	On when ranked 1st or 2nd

- **Settings → Reminders** holds a master switch, the priority order with arrows to re-rank it, a switch and a plain reason for each reminder, the bill timing (on the day, 1, 3 or 7 days before), and a test reminder that arrives about 10 seconds later.
- **Re-ranking updates the reminders you never touched** and leaves the ones you set by hand alone. Setting a switch back to its suggested state hands it back to the priorities.
- **Nothing is sent if reminders are off** in onboarding or in Settings, or if Android has blocked notifications for FinAssist.

Checked on the emulator: Android asked for notification permission, the app scheduled its reminders, a test reminder arrived while the app was closed, and tapping it opened FinAssist.

4. What was removed or replaced along the way

Removed or replaced	Reason
Facebook sign-in	Never configured on any platform.
Currency picker	The plan is peso-only.
Financial health score	Not in the plan; Reports shows real figures instead.
Separate expenses list	Merged into the one Transactions screen (Phase 5).
Add Income dialog, Add Budget dialog	Replaced by the income waterfall and the Safe to Spend editor.
Category Budgets	Removed on request: Safe to Spend already limits daily spending, and category budgets are not in the plan.
Old Insights screen	Replaced by Reports, which reads the wallet ledger.
Notifications screen and bell	Removed in Phase 1; real phone reminders replace it in Phase 9.

5. Known gaps and things still to verify

- **Dashboard tip banner (plan 8.4, marked build now):** not built. The rule-based insight card and the "Bills due soon" notice cover part of it.
- **Attaching a receipt photo to a bill payment (plan 8.10):** not built. It needs a decision on where photos are stored.
- **Scan Receipt and Voice Log buttons inside the Add Expense form (plan 8.8):** not there yet. Both features exist as their own screens from Home, but they only show the text they read.
- **The old *expenses* records are still written** alongside the wallet ledger. Nothing reads them now, so the duplicate write can be dropped.
- **Security and Help & Support** in Settings still say "coming soon".
- **Firestore rules:** the repository's *firestore.rules* limits each user to their own data, but the published rules live in a Firebase project owned by a classmate and have not been compared against the file.
- **The import of pre-wallet records has never been run on real old data**, only on test data.
- **Reminders arrive a few minutes late at worst.** Exact-to-the-minute alarms need a permission most users deny, so the app uses the relaxed kind. Bills are scheduled about a month ahead and re-planned whenever the app is opened or the data changes.

6. What is left, and the plan for each

Phase 10 — History & Reconciliation Timeline and Settings polish (last core phase)

- A history timeline of pay cycles, newest first: the period, what came in, what went to bills and goals, what was left, and the decision made, with its done, declined or pending badge. Tapping a pending one opens the leftover review so it can still be settled.
- Settings: edit the income profile (source, frequency, usual amount), a default choice for leftover money, manage expense categories, a shortcut to wallets, and a default for the privacy mask. Re-ranking priorities and light/dark mode are already there.
- Close the core gaps listed above: the Dashboard tip banner, and the receipt photo on a bill payment once storage is decided.
- Optional, and needs a decision: a Filipino/English toggle. The plan calls it a nice-to-have, and it means translating every screen.

Phases 11–16 — the AI and ML track

Phase	Plan
11 — Receipt scanning	The app already reads text from a receipt photo on the phone. The work left is pulling the total, date and shop name out of that text and filling in the Add Expense form for the user to check and save, plus the same button on a bill payment.
12 — Voice logging	Speech to text already works on the phone. The work left is understanding a sentence such as "spent 150 on food from GCash", filling in the form, and asking the user to confirm before saving.
13 — AI insights	Replace the rule-based insight lines and the tip banner with generated ones, sending only totals and category summaries, never raw transactions. The current rule-based lines stay as the fallback when offline.
14 — AI chatbot	The assistant answers from fixed keyword rules today. Connecting it to a real model needs a small server (for example Firebase Cloud Functions, which requires the paid plan) so the API key is never inside the app. The finance-only guard and the offline notice stay.
15 — Financial tips	A server job collects tips from trusted Philippine sources, saves them with their source and date, and the Reports tips panel shows the saved copy, including offline.
16 — Offline assistant	When there is no connection, answer from the rules and the user's own figures instead of the model, so the assistant is never simply dead.

Decisions the team needs to make before Phases 11–16

- Which AI service the chatbot and insights will use, and who pays for it.
- Whether we may add a small server for API keys and the tips job. The Firebase project is owned by a classmate and would need its plan upgraded.
- Where receipt photos are stored, since that also costs money once there are many of them.
- Which Philippine sources the financial tips may be taken from.
- Whether the app must also run on iOS. Everything so far is set up and tested for Android.

7. How to run and check the app

- **Run it:** `flutter emulators --launch FinAssist_Pixel`, wait for the phone to start, then `flutter run -d emulator-5554` from the project folder.
- **Run the tests:** `flutter test` — 231 tests covering the money rules, pay periods, bills, goals, debts, reports and reminders, plus the screens themselves.
- **Check the code:** `flutter analyze` — currently clean.
- **Reminders:** Settings → Reminders → Send a Test Reminder, then leave the app; the reminder arrives about 10 seconds later.

8. For the developer taking the next phase

Where things live

Folder	What is in it
lib/models	The money rules as plain Dart with no Firebase: pay periods and Safe to Spend, bills and their occurrences, the income plan, goals, debts, reports and reminders. This is where logic belongs, because it can be tested directly.
lib/services	Everything that talks to Firestore, one file per area, plus firestore_write.dart, which records without waiting so the app works offline.
lib/screens	One file per screen.
lib/widgets	Pieces shared between screens: the Safe to Spend card, the transaction row, sheets for bills, goals and debts, the charts, and the dialog kit.
lib/theme	Colours for light and dark mode and the button styles that carry the green, red and blue rule.
test/widget_test.dart	All 231 tests in one file, grouped by feature.

Conventions worth keeping

- **Put the thinking in lib/models.** Screens read data and draw; the rules sit in functions that take plain values and a date, which is why they can be tested without a phone.
- **Screens take their data as optional streams** and their actions as optional callbacks, with the live Firebase versions as the defaults. Tests pass fixed data instead.
- **Write money changes in one batch** with the wallet balance, the way paying a bill or confirming income already does, so nothing can half-save.
- **Never await a Firestore write** in the UI. Use `commitFirestoreWrite`, so recording works offline.
- **Keep the button colours:** green commits, red destroys or backs out, blue opens or edits. Amounts go through `formatPeso` or `MoneyText`, which also respects the privacy mask.
- **Add tests with the work.** Run `flutter test` and `flutter analyze` before committing; both are clean today.